Quick Start — Your First Automation in 15 Minutes

You do not need to read the whole guide first. Do this:

- **Minutes 0–2 — Pick one repetitive task.** The best first automation is something you do at least 3 times a week and dislike: email triage, repurposing a post, or chasing an invoice.
- **Minutes 2–5 — Open the matching workflow.** The 10 workflows are in prompts/. Each file has copy-paste prompts. Pick the one that matches your task.
- **Minutes 5–10 — Run the first prompt.** Paste your own text into the [BRACKETS], run it in your AI chat tool, and read the output once. Fix names, numbers, and dates.
- **Minutes 10–13 — Save what worked.** Save the prompt and the output together (a note, a doc, a text file). Next time you run it in 2 minutes instead of 10.
- **Minutes 13–15 — Put it on the worksheet.** Fill in the first row of the Automation Worksheet: the task, the workflow used, and how long it took. That is your baseline.

Next steps

- Tomorrow: run the same workflow again. It gets faster the second time.
- This week: pick two more automations with the audit checklist.
- Spreadsheets and scripts: open the Profit Calculator first — it takes 2 minutes and shows your numbers clearly.

If something does not work

Check the setup guides first (scripts/README.md, spreadsheets/README.md, no-code/README.md). The Python scripts print plain-English errors. The Google Apps Script snippets only run inside Google Sheets.